

ies—decent ergonomics, good build quality and a 5 megapixel camera that actually shoots videos in up to VGA (640 x 480 pixels) resolution. The Viewty also supports WMV and DivX video playback, somewhat of a rarity. A large 3 inch screen dominates proceedings although the Viewty does (shockingly!) without WLAN, and any sort of keypad, or menu buttons, save one very iPhone like menu button. Sad to say device navigation isn't really helped by this lack of interface. The touchscreen does remedy things but finger touch control isn't as good as we'd have liked (the iPod Touch spoils us silly). The stylus is a saviour of sorts. LGs menu system is reasonably intuitive, and we found no noteworthy complaint.

It loses out in terms of performance to the two shining Nokias, in nearly every test, and we'd like to see improvements in the music player quality, and signal quality tests. As a camera phone the Viewty is good, but not as good as the other five megapixel offerings available. At Rs 20,490 the large touchscreen may be nifty enough for you to skip the Nokia's and pick this up. If you have the moolah, spend a little more and get one of the two above.

Samsung U900

Sick-slick slider

Samsung makes excellent sliders. Definitely true, if the U900 is any indication. Besides being very well built, slim, and featuring a brushed metal body, the U900 has a lovely, (if somewhat small), screen. It's compact too, and very much for the college goer looking for something powerful and chic. The call accept/reject button are large, you could find them with your eyes closed. The keypad seems reminiscent of Motorola phones, some sort of a membrane based keypad



LG KU990 (Viewty)



Samsung U900

that nonetheless works fine. The most innovative feature is incorporated into the menu button—there is none! What you have instead is an OLED lit pad that is touch and swipe sensitive and works beautifully. The back-light activates according to the feature you select. For example using the down backlit arrow on the joypad will cause the down arrow to get highlighted. Although this is little more than a gimmick, it's original, and works well, which is more important.

Samsung's five megapixel camera is easy to use with good menus and options, although its camera isn't as good as the N95 8GB or the N82. The only trick which Samsung may have missed is the presence of GPS and WLAN

as features, and for the price point we'd have expected something like this included. At Rs 20,035 the U900 is a good phone for someone looking at something cute, hardy, yet functional. It hasn't got the powerful convergence of features like the N95 8GB and N82, but it looks radically different and is flashy too, like the Viewty. Choose it over the two Nokia's above only if you don't need the extra features they have.

Sony Ericsson K850i

Click, flash, smile...

The K850i targets users desiring a good camera phone—exactly what their K750i achieved some three years back. This is a device that will strike you with its sheer build quality—it's like a little rock, and feels exceptionally solid in hand.



Sony Ericsson K850i

The colour scheme is cool—shiny black with dark green stripes down the sides and on the joypad—and is an attention grabber. The other thing that will attract you immediately is the compact dimensions of this phone. The only minus as a result of this is the very small number keys on the phone, thanks to which the edges of your fingers will get sore after a lot of SMS typing—a saving grace is that the keypads well spaced out, else this device would be a spectacular failure.

Sony Ericsson provides good PMP capabilities, a good music and video player menu system, and good stereo sound. The camera that the "K" series are famous for is the pinnacle of SE's cameras—5 megapixels coupled with the Xenon flash, although continuous usage reveals a quirky flash. It's every bit as good as the N95 8GBs camera, perhaps a little better on the clarity front, although we'd like our colours to be a little more natural with un-highlighted contrasts. But the K850i's camera scores in one aspect—getting good shots requires less tinkering with settings than Nokia's phones, which give you great quality only when the settings are configured properly.

For Rs 20,000 the K850i is an excellent little phone. Although its not as feature-rich as the N95 8GB, it's a very different device, focussed more on the user who wants something compact, and more handy to pull off a couple of quick shots. For those wanting a huge feature list look elsewhere. This one focuses on being a king of a few trades, and not a jack of many.

Going Corporate On A Budget

PDA Phones up to Rs 20,000

This category spanned seven phones. Such business devices represent the lower-end of the PDA/business smartphone market, where price is an important consideration, and features are second in terms of priority. Such phones are sought by those looking for a PDA-like experience for cheap. Such users may or may not have serious business usage in mind, and these devices will shed hardcore business features for a more generalist feature set. Don't expect great QWERTY keypads, and certain advanced features like GPS may be unavailable. Some phones may also have certain hardcore business features and give up some multimedia capabilities. Whatever your requirements are, you'll find a surprising variety of phones here, with a startling variety of features.

HTC P3470

Mediocre looks

HTC's P3470 is a PDA phone based around a Windows Mobile (WM) 6.0 Pro OS. It's rather plain to look at and will garner no beauty accolades. Although build quality is good, nothing is inspiring. The lack of a QWERTY and any form of number pad will ensure that serious PDA users will look elsewhere. Due to this glaring omission the P3470 has ergonomic issues. Its camera and multimedia properties aren't

too fancy either, although the features are available. More importantly the phone lags slightly—this indicates a slower processor. Call clarity is about par with what is acceptable, nothing more.

Although the P3470 is reasonably compact it's nowhere as attractive as the ASUS P320, nor as functional as its costlier sibling the Ty TN II, and for Rs 19,990 we can't recommend it to anyone.

LG KS20

Tasteful design

The KS20 borrows deeply from LGs desire to make hot devices for the young, urbane crowd. Unfortunately, too much of a good thing kills as the proverb goes, and the chrome down the sides of a shiny black exterior may be viewed as garish or tasteful—depending of course on your aesthetic senses. While the device fits the hand well, it also has a couple of glaring ergonomic issues. For one, the joystick's a total pain to use, and navigation is irritating. Although based on WM 6.0 Pro means application support will be very good, the KS20 seems to be more of a lifestyle device than a serious PDA as both number and QWERTY keypads are absent. This also means that the device is quite compact and lightweight, despite retaining a screen size of 2.8 inches.

The camera and music performance was about par, although it takes more to impress. Once again a nifty add-on by LG is the ability for this phone to play DivX



HTC P3470



Nokia E61i



LG KS20

videos, like the KU990 (Viewty). Video playback was also pretty good, and this makes the KS20 somewhat of a saving grace. Its also one of the few PDA phones to support FM Radio, which is rarity for business devices. At Rs 19,990 the KS20 is a stylish device to be sure, but there are better PDAs and better cellphones available at the same price point, which leaves the KS20 out in the cold.

Nokia E61i

The Incredible Bulk

Nokia's E61 and E62 belong to a family of phones spawned by Nokia's obsession with sumo wrestlers or some other monolithic object. The E61 suffixed with an "i" for a camera, is a bulky device that's quite well built, and features a well laid out, and spacious QWERTY keypad, that was slightly improved ergonomically over the keypads of the E61 and the E62. These phones aren't PDAs in the truest sense, as document creating and advanced editing isn't possible and Nokia themselves prefer the term *business phones*.

The screen itself is beautiful at 2.8 inches, and features 16 million colours. Sadly there's no touch functionality which would have been a productive and nifty add on. The beauty of the E61i lies in its simplicity however, and as a business phone to type out mails, or for long hours on call (thanks to the huge battery) it makes perfect sense. The camera itself is no great shakes, and the audio qualities of this phone are limited. However video playback is fun due to the screen. At Rs 18,299 the E61i is quite expensive for the features it offers—which will satisfy neither the diehard business user, nor the diehard multimedia junkie. Also at the price, much better options in each usage sphere exist.